



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

idaṃ* ca roga+vyasanaṃ* prajānāṃ* |
paśyaṃś* ca viśrambham upaiti lokaḥ |
(vistīrṇam a+jñānam Cvistīrṇa+vijñānam)aho narāṇāṃ* |
hasanti ye roga+bhayair* a+muktāḥ | |3.46|
nīvartyatāṃ* sūta (bahiḥ+Cvahiḥ+)prayāṇān* |
nara+indra+sadma*eva rathaḥ prayātu |
śrutvā ca me roga+bhayaṃ* ratibhyaḥ |
pratyāhataṃ* saṃkucati*iva cetaḥ | |3.47|

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

He observes that humanity, despite being constantly threatened by illness, continues to live with a false sense of security, reveling in pleasures as though immune to life's inevitable hardships. This ignorance, this vast expanse of unknowing, is what Siddhartha laments. He sees people laughing and enjoying themselves, completely oblivious to the ever-present danger of sickness.

Deeply affected by this revelation, Siddhartha orders his charioteer to turn back, directing the chariot to return to the palace. The joy he once found in worldly pleasures has been shattered. The very thought of disease fills him with dread, causing his heart to shrink, to contract with fear and a growing awareness of life's fragility. He can no longer partake in the superficial happiness that surrounds him, knowing that it is built on a foundation of denial.

This passage speaks directly to your own life. How often do you, too, find yourself caught up in the pursuit of fleeting pleasures, ignoring the underlying reality of suffering? Modern society often encourages this very behavior: distraction, consumption, and the avoidance of difficult truths. Siddhartha's experience serves as a wake-up call. It asks you to confront the reality of sickness, aging, and death, not with despair, but with awareness. By acknowledging these truths, you can cultivate compassion, wisdom, and a deeper appreciation for the present moment. No amount of wealth or status can shield you from the common destiny of all beings. This understanding can free you from the endless cycle of desire and aversion, guiding you toward a more meaningful existence rooted in empathy and acceptance. Let Siddhartha's initial shock be a catalyst for your own spiritual awakening, prompting you to live with greater intention and kindness.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate a greater awareness of suffering in your own life and use that awareness to fuel compassion and wisdom?